

Cave, Cape and World Stone: Kin Across Five Centuries

On Okinawa's east coast, a monk's limestone cave, a coral-reef bay and a stone carved with an emigrant's vow explain a town shaped by leaving and returning: centuries as a Ryukyuan district, the age of emigration to Hawaii and the Philippines, a wartime prisoner camp, and the Marine Corps base that today covers much of Kin.



金武町（沖縄県）

In this dossier

1. A history of the district (6 chapters, about 2000 words)
2. Timeline
3. Walking notes, walk map and photographs of the stops
4. Then and now: aerial photographs
5. How the ground was made
6. Disasters remembered
7. Sources (22) and further reading

Written in English from Japanese library sources — chiefly books digitised by the National Diet Library — and official records. Superscript numbers point to the numbered sources at the end, with page frames for the digitised books.

A cape, a bay and a cave

Kin sits on the narrow waist of central Okinawa, where a stubby peninsula and its fringing reef enclose Kin Bay on the island's Pacific side. The Japanese Navy's 1908 pilot guide to these waters charts the bay as a broad, open anchorage exposed to the east and south, its mouth spanned by reef ground reaching about two miles between Kin Cape and the islets of Tsuken and Kudaka; a county gazetteer published in Naha eleven years later borrows the same survey when it describes the cape's reef running two-thirds of a mile out to sea. That 1919 book, written for Kunigami County by the schoolteacher and local historian Shimabukuro Genichiro, also names the peaks behind the town, Kin-dake and Igei-dake, and lists the harbors strung along the coast that Kin village then administered: Ginoza, Kanna and Fukuhana ports to the north, as well as Kin's own anchorage at Tomikura.¹²

The 1908 pilot guide is worth pausing on for another reason: it romanizes the bay as "Chimu Wan" and the cape as "Chimu Saki", the old reading of the place name 金武 used by surveyors and, later, by the wartime US forces who built an airstrip on the peninsula and knew it as Chimu Airfield. The same 1919 gazetteer records that in the 1670s, in the Ryukyu Kingdom's own administrative reshuffling, land was cut from Nago and from Kin to found the new district of Kushi — evidence that Kin already existed as an established magiri, or district, more than three and a half centuries ago, its bounds at that time reaching inland to take in the hamlets that would only in the twentieth century become the separate village of Ginoza.¹²¹⁰

Local tradition places another arrival on this coast two centuries earlier still. A wandering monk named Nisshu, born in Kii province around 1503, is said to have set out on a votive sea voyage in search of Kannon's paradise across the southern seas, been driven off course, and washed up at Kin's small port of Fukka in 1522. Finding a deep limestone cave open to the shore, he is said to have taken it for a dwelling of the bodhisattva Kannon, carved three images for it with his own hands, and founded the temple that still stands over the cave mouth as Kimpuzan Kin Kannon-ji. Nisshu went on, by the same tradition, to restore Naminoue Shrine and Gokoku-ji in Naha before ending his life in Satsuma; the 1919 county gazetteer already lists his grave, the temple and the port of Fukka among Kin village's "notable places and historic remains", confirming that the story was well established locally within four centuries of the event it describes.¹¹⁵

The village that sent its sons to Hawaii

Kin's modern fame rests on a single, closely dated episode. Toyama Kyuzo, a Kin-born teacher and prefectural assemblyman, spent the 1890s lobbying Okinawa's government to let islanders emigrate for work, against officials who feared the loss of labor, remittances, and face. Failing to move them, he organized the passage privately: a party left Naha and sailed from Yokohama on the steamer China, and on 8 January 1900 twenty-six contract laborers walked onto the Honolulu docks to begin work on Oahu's sugar plantations. Okinawa's prefectural archives record that ten of the twenty-six were young men from Kin itself. From his own village, Toyama had opened a migration that the archives put at about 3,225 people sent abroad from Kin by the time the war cut off overseas emigration in 1941.⁶⁷

Toyama did not stop at Hawaii. A letter he wrote in September 1907 to a former comrade from Okinawa's freedom-and-rights movement, Taira Shinsuke, by then settled in North America, claims credit for having already sent about five thousand Okinawans abroad — some four thousand to Hawaii and the rest to Mexico, Peru, New Caledonia, the Philippines and Canada — and describes the whole prefecture as "day and night absorbed in plans for going overseas". He had already started an emigrants' newspaper to shield migrants from predatory brokers, and was preparing to found a protective association to do the same. A guidebook to Ryukyu published in 1926, sixteen years after Toyama's death, still measured his legacy in the household economics of his own village: villagers of Kin, it reports, had by mutual agreement capped their evening drinking to five go of awamori a month — and were keeping to it — the book's own example of a new frugality then spreading across the prefecture.³⁸

The same 1926 book locates Toyama's memorial in the landscape rather than in a museum case: his defiant call to leave — "Let us go: our home is the five continents" — was cut into a stone that still stands on a low hill in Kin, a stone that villagers had already taken to calling simply the "World Stone". A matching marble stone from Kin, carrying the same verse, was

unveiled at the Hawaii Okinawa Center in Honolulu in January 2000 to mark the centenary of the crossing.³⁹¹⁹

Across the Pacific to Davao

Hawaii is the destination Kin is remembered for, but two directories of overseas Okinawans compiled in the late 1930s show a second, less celebrated stream running to the Philippines. Abaca — Manila hemp, the fiber crop that supplied the world's rope — drew thousands of Okinawan laborers to plantations around Davao on Mindanao from the 1900s, many of them recruited through the Japanese firm Ota Kogyo. A 1937 directory of Japanese abroad and a 1938 gazetteer of prominent Okinawans between them name a run of Kin men who made that crossing: Igei Man'ei, born in Kin in 1892, who landed at Davao in 1912 and went to work for Ota Kogyo; Tsukayama Chosho, from Kin's Kanna hamlet, who reached the Davao anchorage of Talomo in August 1918 to grow abaca and later headed a branch of the local Japanese association; and Shimabukuro Chujiro, from Kin's Kochiya hamlet, who landed at Davao in 1919, worked the Royan plantation for two years, then joined Ota Kogyo's Santiago branch.⁴⁵

The same volumes credit a Kin-born planter, Oshiro Kozo, born in 1881, with a reputation among Japanese settlers as a benefactor of Philippine colonization and the head of a colonization company at Bago — a Davao district that still carries his name today, as Bago Oshiro, and Kin remembers him as the father of Philippine emigration, who went out with the 1904 emigration to Benguet before turning to abaca at Bago — while a Kin man named Takaesu Izo, a graduate of the prefecture's First Middle School, moved on from an early spell at Davao to head a fishery cooperative at Iloilo. Other entries follow local men into commerce in Manila and into the Japanese army: none of it as famous as the Hawaii crossing, but together the entries show that by the interwar years Kin's emigrants, and the money and letters they sent home, reached well beyond the plantations of Oahu. Some of the men named in these directories came from hamlets — Kanna, Kochiya, and the village of Ginoza itself — that were still legally part of Kin at the time, and would separate to form Ginoza village only in April 1946.⁴⁵¹²¹⁸²²

Invasion, occupation and a village split in two

Okinawa's prefectural archives date the war's approach to Kin precisely: reconnaissance and target photography from September 1944 through the following March, a squadron of Japanese suicide boats based at Kin and the neighboring hamlet of Yaka from January 1945, the American landing on the island's central-west coast on 1 April 1945, and the occupation of Kin village itself four days later, on 5 April. Within the year a detention camp had gone up at Yaka to hold captured Japanese soldiers along with civilians and Koreans caught up in the fighting; the site remains commemorated in the town, and Kin still holds an annual Yaka-bushi singing contest each August in honor of a folk song that local sources trace to that camp.⁶¹³

Remarkably, one substantial prewar building came through the battle standing: the main hall of Kin Kannon-ji, rebuilt in 1942, is described by local heritage writers as the only such wooden building on Okinawa's main island to have escaped the fires of 1945. The cave beneath it, Nisshu-do, was itself registered as a national Monument by Japan's Agency for Cultural Affairs on 17 February 2026, cited for its roughly thirteen-meter-high inner chamber reached from within the temple grounds.¹⁴¹⁶

Occupation reorganized Kin's map as well as its economy. On 1 April 1946 the northern hamlets of the old Kin village — Kochiya (renamed Matsuda), Ginoza, Sokei and Kanna among them — were split off under the US military government to form the new village of Ginoza, whose own official history still describes the pre-1946 area as "Kin village", the same administrative unit the 1919 gazetteer and the 1930s emigrant directories describe. What remained was a smaller Kin, its old airfield on the peninsula soon repurposed: the prefectural archives record it in use as a firing range from 1947 and record fresh petitions over replacement land following a Marine Corps build-up in 1957, part of the process that made the base at Kin, later named Camp Hansen, into the fixture that still dominates the town. Camp Hansen is named for Private Dale M. Hansen, a US Marine from Nebraska awarded the Medal of Honor after his death for a one-man assault on Japanese positions on 7 May 1945; he died on Okinawa four days later. It is one of the island's installations that carry the names of eight Medal of Honor recipients of the battle.⁶¹²²⁰²¹

Reversion and the base-town economy

Okinawa, including Kin, remained under US administration for twenty-seven years after the war, returning to Japanese sovereignty only in 1972; Kin itself gained formal town status, and its present name of Kin-cho, in 1980. Camp Hansen never went away in the meantime, and an exhibition drawn from the prefectural archives in 2019 put the share of Kin's total area occupied by US military facilities at roughly fifty-six percent — context for a townscape in which the base's perimeter fence is often only a street away from ordinary houses and shops.^{6 10}

That proximity produced its own culture. Just outside one of Camp Hansen's gates, the district known as Shinkaichi grew up from the 1950s as an entertainment strip serving the base, its bars, tailors and restaurants at their busiest during the Vietnam War years. It was here, at a small diner called Parlor Senri, that the proprietor Gibo Senri is credited by the town's own tourism authority with inventing taco rice around 1984: Mexican taco fillings spooned over plain rice instead of a tortilla, devised as a filling, inexpensive meal for young American servicemen. The dish spread across Okinawa through the 1990s and is now sold as far away as convenience stores and school lunches, but Kin still calls itself its birthplace.¹¹

Reading the ground today

Little of Kin's pre-war built fabric survived 1945, which makes the handful of true survivals worth seeking out deliberately: the 1942 hall over Nisshu's cave; and the 1935 Toyama Memorial Hall, a rare pre-war reinforced-concrete building designed by the Okinawan architect Oshiro Ryutaro and paid for, fittingly, from money left over after the town raised Toyama's statue. Used afterwards as a kindergarten, a town office and an education-board building, the hall was restored to its original appearance and reopened in October 2016, and in February 2021 it became Kin's first nationally Registered Tangible Cultural Property.⁹

Behind the built history, the land itself still shows what the sources describe: the mangrove-lined estuary of the Okukubi River east of the old village center, cited today as the only place on Okinawa's main island where all four native mangrove species grow together, sits exactly where the 1919 gazetteer placed Kin's spring-fed lowland, and the wells and taro paddies still worked in the valley draw on the same limestone groundwater the old sources took for granted. Aerial coverage available for this dossier's companion photo pages begins only in the 1970s, after reversion; the US forces who administered Okinawa before then held their own imagery of the landing beaches and the airfield years earlier; readers wanting to see Kin during the occupation itself will need to look to American, not Japanese, archives.^{1 10 17}

Timeline

1522	The monk Nisshu is said to wash ashore at Kin's port of Fukka and found Kin Kannon-ji over a limestone cave. ^{15 16}
mid-1600s	Kin exists as an established Ryukyuan magiri (district), its bounds reaching inland to hamlets that will not separate until 1946. ¹¹²
1670s	Land is cut from Nago and Kin to found the new district of Kushi, in the kingdom's own administrative reorganization. ¹
1899-1900	Toyama Kyuzo organizes Okinawa's first group emigration; the party reaches Honolulu on 8 January 1900, twenty-six strong, ten of them from Kin. ^{6 7}
1907	Toyama writes that about 5,000 Okinawans have emigrated under his arrangements, chiefly to Hawaii. ⁸
1908	Japan's Hydrographic Department surveys Kin Bay and Cape, romanizing the name as "Chimu". ²
1912-1919	Kin villagers land at Davao in the Philippines to grow abaca on plantations run by firms such as Ota Kogyo. ^{4 5}
1935	The Toyama Memorial Hall is completed in Kin, designed by Oshiro Ryutaro. ⁹
1941	Wartime conditions end overseas emigration; the town's own count puts Kin's total emigrants sent since 1899 at about 3,225. ⁶
1 April - 5 April 1945	US forces land on Okinawa's central-west coast and occupy Kin village within days; a detention camp is soon set up at Yaka. ⁶
1 April 1946	Kochiya, Ginoza, Sokei and Kanna separate from Kin village to form Ginoza village under the US military government. ¹²
1947-1957	The former Kin airfield becomes a US forces firing range, then, after a 1957 Marine build-up, the base later named Camp Hansen. ⁶
1972 / 1980	Okinawa reverts to Japanese sovereignty in 1972; Kin gains town status in 1980. ¹⁰
1984	Gibo Senri is credited with inventing taco rice at Parlor Senri in Kin's Shinkaichi entertainment district. ¹¹
2016 / 2021 / 2026	The Toyama Memorial Hall reopens after restoration (2016) and is registered as a cultural property (2021); Kin Kannon-ji's cave is registered as a national Monument (17 February 2026). ^{9 14}

Walking notes

Places to stand and look, in walking order. Straight-line distances only; check today's access and opening before you go.

- 1 Kin Kannon-ji and Nisshu-do cave** 金峯山金武観音寺・日秀洞. A 1942 wooden hall, said to be the only one of its kind on Okinawa's main island to have escaped the 1945 battle, stands over a limestone cave whose roughly 13-meter inner chamber was registered a national Monument in February 2026; look for the shrine-and-temple images sharing the same precinct, a survival of pre-Meiji religious practice. ^{14 16} [map](#)
- 2 Toyama Memorial Hall** 當山記念館. A 1935 reinforced-concrete hall with a curved, beamless ceiling and round windows, designed by Oshiro Ryutaro and funded from the surplus of Toyama Kyuzo's statue fund; restored and reopened in 2016 and registered as a national cultural property in 2021, it now displays material on Kin's emigration history; admission is free, weekdays 9:00-16:00. ⁹
- 3 Toyama Kyuzo's statue and the "World Stone"** 當山久三の像・世界石. A statue of the emigration pioneer stands near the memorial hall; a verse stone nearby, which villagers came to call the "World Stone", carries Toyama's own call to leave for the wider world, a companion to a matching stone later placed at the Hawaii Okinawa Center. ^{3 9 19}

- 4 **Yaka** 屋嘉. The hamlet west of the old village center where a US detention camp held Japanese soldiers, civilians and Koreans from 1945; the town's annual Yaka-bushi singing contest each August commemorates a folk song local histories trace to the camp. ⁶¹³ [map](#)
- 5 **Shinkaichi and the taco rice diners** 新開地. The strip of bars and restaurants that grew up outside a Camp Hansen gate from the 1950s; a diner here is credited with inventing taco rice around 1984 to feed young servicemen cheaply and quickly. ¹¹ [map](#)
- 6 **Okukubi River mangroves** 億首川. An estuary east of the town center where all four mangrove species found on the Okinawan mainland grow; the spring-fed valley behind it still carries the taro paddies and wells that the area's limestone groundwater has supported for generations. ^{110 17} [map](#)

Walk map



The walking stops, numbered as in the notes, on the latest GSI aerial photograph (10.0 × 7.1 km, north up). Lines join the stops in order and are not a route; follow streets on the ground. Stops not shown: 2, 3. Each stop in the notes links to a map app.

- | | | | |
|---|--|---|---|
| 1 | Kin Kannon-ji and Nisshu-do cave map↗ | 4 | Yaka map↗ |
| 2 | Toyama Memorial Hall | 5 | Shinkaichi and the taco rice diners map↗ |
| 3 | Toyama Kyuzo's statue and the "World Stone" | 6 | Okukubi River mangroves map↗ |

The stops today

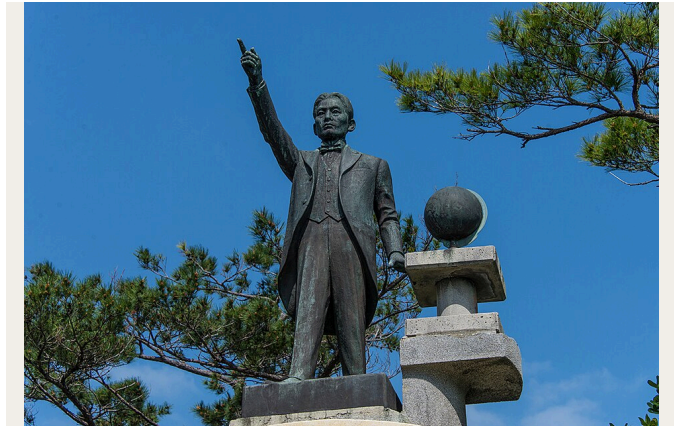
Recent photographs of the stops, numbered as in the walking notes. Each was checked against the place the note describes; the line under the name says what it shows.



1. Kin Kannon-ji and Nisshu-do cave

The wooden main hall of Kin Kannon-ji

"KinKannonji" by Muramasa, CC BY-SA 3.0, via Wikimedia Commons



3. Toyama Kyuzo's statue and the "World Stone"

The bronze statue of Toyama Kyuzo, with one arm raised

"Kyuzo Toyama statue" by visitkintown, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons



4. Yaka

No reusable ground-level photograph shows this place, so here is the latest GSI aerial photograph of the spot (ringed), north up, about 480 m across.

Aerial photograph: Geospatial Information Authority of Japan (GSI), seamless aerial photos



5. Shinkaichi and the taco rice diners

No reusable ground-level photograph shows this place, so here is the latest GSI aerial photograph of the spot (ringed), north up, about 480 m across.

Aerial photograph: Geospatial Information Authority of Japan (GSI), seamless aerial photos



6. Okukubi River mangroves

No reusable ground-level photograph shows this place, so here is the latest GSI aerial photograph of the spot (ringed), north up, about 480 m across.

Aerial photograph: Geospatial Information Authority of Japan (GSI), seamless aerial photos

No picture for stop 2: no reusable photograph shows the place the note describes, and its position is not certain enough for an aerial view.

The same ground, 1974–1978 and 2023



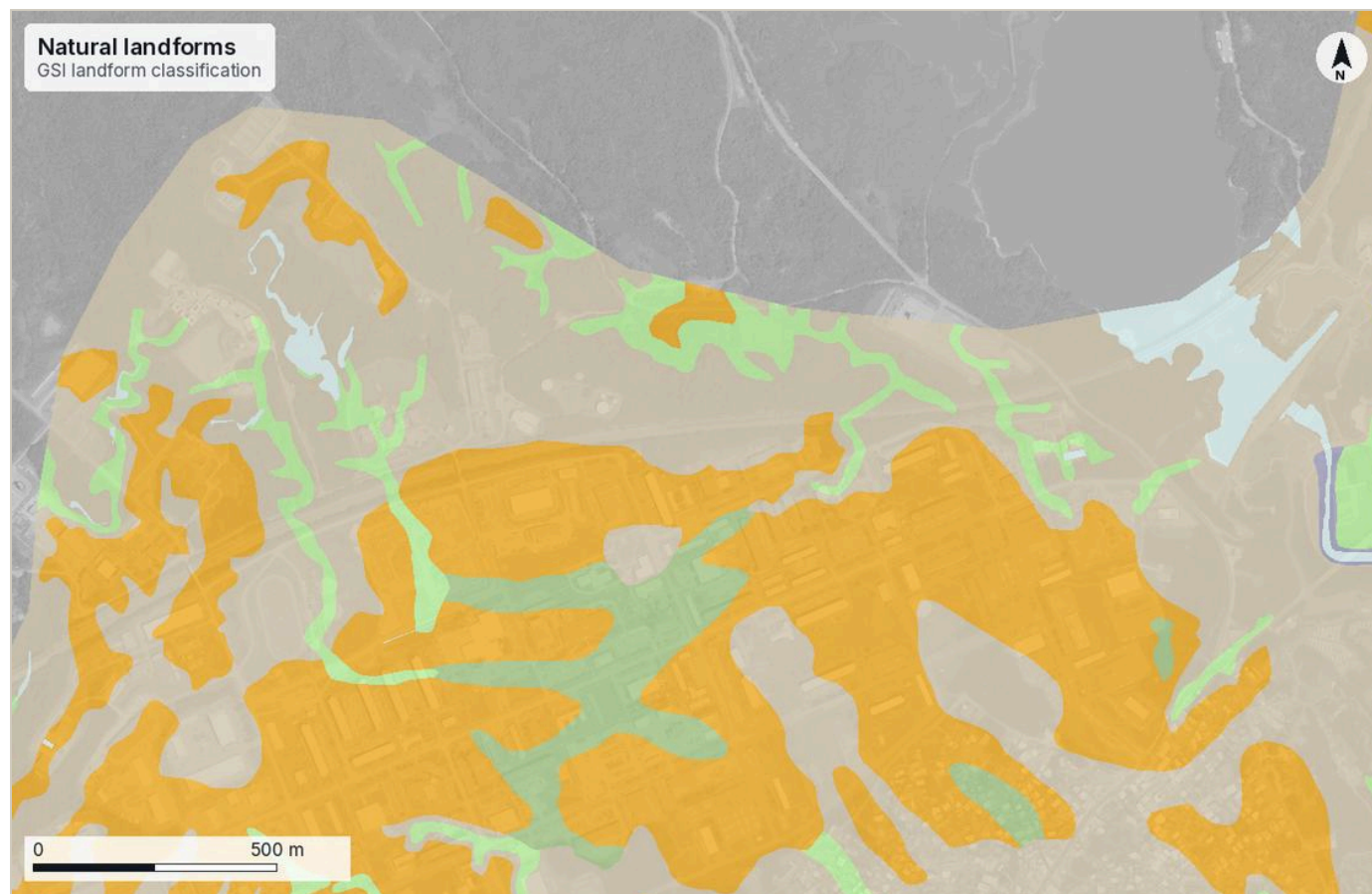
1974–1978 aerial photograph — GSI Tiles *gazo1*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. North is up; the frame is identical in both images.



2023 annual orthophoto — GSI Tiles *nendophoto2023*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. Capture dates within a mosaic can differ from place to place.

How to compare. Anchor on features that rarely move — river banks, rail lines, shrine and temple grounds, main roads — then look for what changed around them. Differences in tone come from film, camera and season, not from the land itself.

Rivers, shorelines and terraces



Natural landforms as classified by GSI, over a recent aerial photograph in gray. Dark blue outlines mark former river channels.

 Mountain and hill slopes 36%	 Plateaus and terraces 27%
 Floodplain and coastal plain 4.8%	 Hollows and shallow valleys 3.3%
 Water 2.0%	

What the main landforms mean

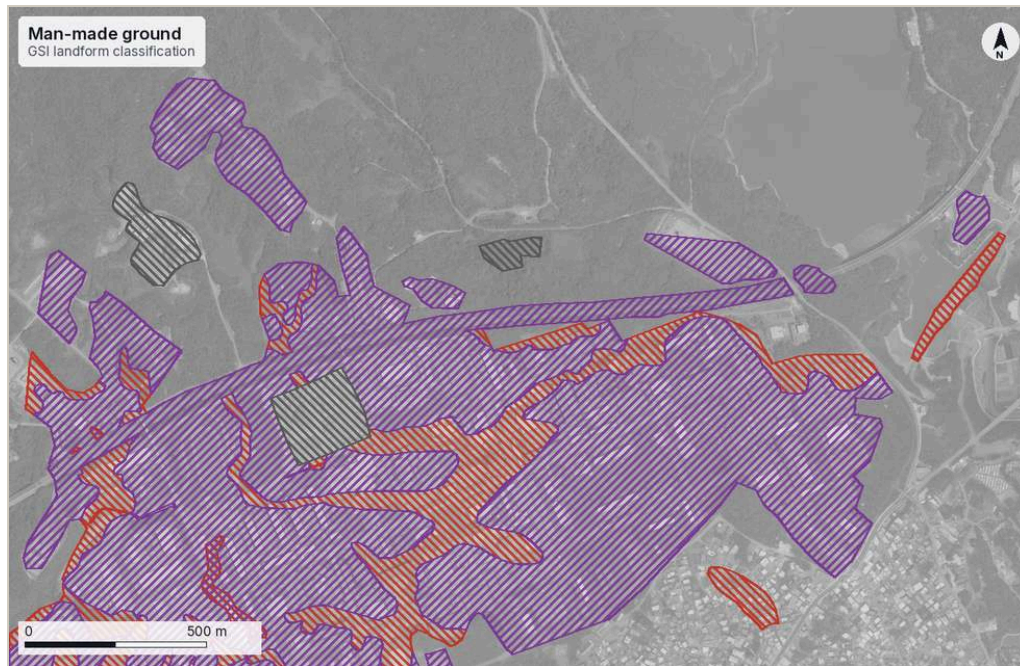
Mountain and hill slopes (36%). Ridges, valleys and fairly steep ground, including terrace-scarp slopes and volcanic ground. Heavy rain or earthquakes can trigger slope failures, debris flows and landslides.

Plateaus and terraces (27%). Flat ground standing in steps above its surroundings, left behind as the land around it was eroded. River flooding is rarely a threat unless the terrace is only slightly above the river; watch the slopes at its edges. Firm ground: shaking is relatively weak and liquefaction is unlikely.

Floodplain and coastal plain (4.8%). Low, flat ground of little relief, built from sand and mud left by floods, or former seabed that emerged. River flooding. Ground is softer nearer the coast and shakes somewhat more; liquefaction tendency is strong on coastal plains and somewhat strong on floodplains. Storm surge near the coast.

Descriptions translated and condensed from GSI's landform-classification legend. They describe tendencies of each landform type, not the condition of any individual plot.

Fill, reclamation and the fields beneath the town



Hatching: man-made ground as classified by GSI. Teal outlines: former sea, river or pond. Dark blue outlines: former river channels.

Man-made ground

-  Cut ground 32%
-  Filled and reclaimed land 7.5%
-  Under construction when mapped 1.7%

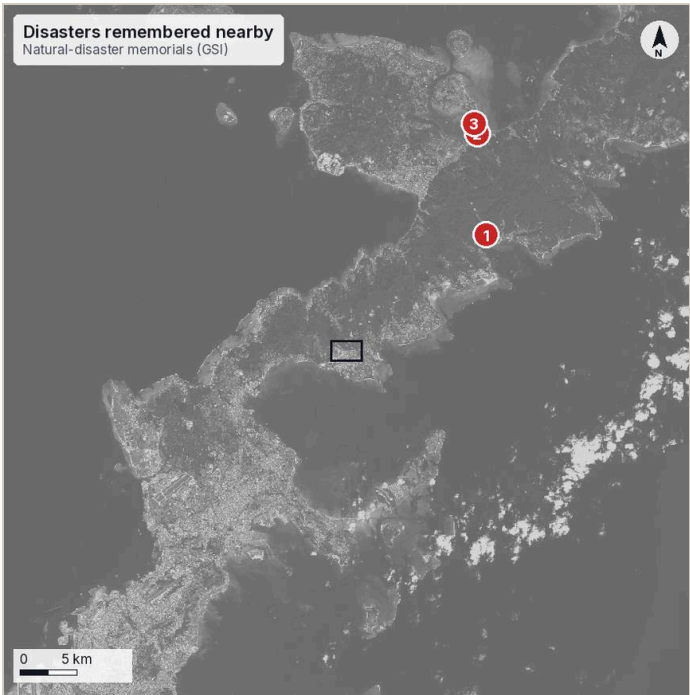
Meiji-era lowland

GSI has not traced Meiji-era lowland for this frame.

Cut ground (32%). Ground made by cutting into slopes of mountains or terrace edges. Depending on the cut slope, heavy rain or earthquakes may bring it down; the ground itself is generally firm.

Filled and reclaimed land (7.5%). Ground raised with fill, land made by dumping soil into the sea, rivers or ponds, or valleys filled in. May flood if not raised enough; on hills, rain or earthquakes can make the fill fail; in lowlands the liquefaction tendency is very strong, especially on filled sea, lake or river beds.

Memorials to natural disasters nearby



Numbered memorials; the black rectangle is the study area of this brief. Frame 60 km across.

Fewer than three memorials stand within 3 km of the study area, so the nearest ones within 30 km are listed.

	Memorial	Disaster	Erected	Distance
1	Monument to the 1960 Chile tsunami at Oura 津波襲来の碑	Chile tsunami (24 May 1960) · tsunami	2012	15.9 km
2	Site of the 1960 Chile tsunami disaster at Makiya 津波被災地跡	Chile tsunami (24 May 1960) · tsunami	1995	22.1 km
3	History of Yagaji Bridge, washed away by the 1960 Chile tsunami 屋我地大橋の歴史	Chile tsunami (24 May 1960) · tsunami	unknown	22.8 km

What the memorials record

1. **Monument to the 1960 Chile tsunami at Oura.** In May 1960 a magnitude 8.5 earthquake in Chile set off a great tsunami that crossed the Pacific to the seas around Japan. It struck here several times, reaching up to 5 m, destroying Oura Bridge and breaking the seawall.
2. **Site of the 1960 Chile tsunami disaster at Makiya.** On 23 May 1960 a magnitude 8.5 earthquake off Chile set off a great tsunami that crossed the Pacific. Makiya Elementary School stood here, and all of its buildings were destroyed by the tsunami; 3 people died in the area.
3. **History of Yagaji Bridge, washed away by the 1960 Chile tsunami.** The first Yagaji Bridge, completed in 1953, was washed away only seven years later by the 1960 tsunami from an earthquake in Chile, almost on the opposite side of the globe.

Source: GSI Natural Disaster Memorials (自然災害伝承碑). English names and notes are Japan Time Atlas translations and summaries of GSI's Japanese descriptions; the memorials' own inscriptions may say more. "Erected" is the year GSI records for the monument.

Sources

1. 島袋源一郎 (Shimabukuro Genichiro), 沖縄県国頭郡志 [Gazetteer of Kunigami County, Okinawa Prefecture], 1919; NDL frames 30, 31, 32, 35, 36, 37, 38. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/960671/1/30> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Kin's historic sites (Kannon-ji, Fukka port, Nisshu's grave), the 1674 split that founded Kushi district, Kin-dake/Igei-dake peaks, Kin village's 1919-era ports, and the bay's reef geography (quoting the 1908 Admiralty survey). Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API (lab.ndl.go.jp's page endpoint returned server errors for this pid).
2. 水路部 (Hydrographic Department, Imperial Japanese Navy), 日本水路誌 [Hydrographic Gazetteer of Japan], 1908; NDL frames 23, 73, 76, 77, 188. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/10304288/1/76> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Physical description of Kin Bay and Cape (reef ground, the roughly two-mile mouth toward Tsuken and Kudaka islands) and the romanized forms "Chimu Wan"/"Chimu Saki", the old reading of Kin behind the wartime "Chimu Airfield" name. Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API.
3. 松岡正男 (Matsuoka Masao), 赤裸々に視た琉球の現状 [The Naked Reality of Ryukyu Today], 1926; NDL frames 15, 16. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/981490/1/15> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Toyama Kyuzo's memorial verse cut into a hillside stone that villagers called the "World Stone", and Kin villagers' agreed monthly cap on awamori drinking as a thrift measure tied to the emigration movement. Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API.
4. 海外研究所 編纂 (Kaigai Kenkyujo, ed.), 海外人事録 [Directory of Japanese Overseas], 1937; NDL frames 74, 90, 94, 96. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/1120586/1/74> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Biographical entries for Kin-born emigrants to the Philippines: Takaesu Izo (fisheries cooperative head), Oshiro Kozo (Davao-area colonization company head), Tsukayama Chosho and Shimabukuro Chujiro (abaca planters at Davao/Talomo). Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API.
5. 海外研究所 編 (Kaigai Kenkyujo, ed.), 現代沖縄県人名鑑 [Directory of Contemporary People of Okinawa Prefecture], 1938; NDL frames 23, 51, 52, 53. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/1219065/1/51> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Further Kin-area emigrant biographies: Igei Man'ei (Davao, Ota Kogyo), Nakama Fukuzo, Nakachi Katsujiro (Manila), and Ashitomi Matsuzo (Sapporo Agricultural College graduate, prefectural technician). Read as OCR snippets via the NDL full-text search API.
6. 金武町移動展 [Traveling exhibition: Kin as seen in the Okinawa Prefectural Archives' collections], 沖縄県公文書館 (Okinawa Prefectural Archives). https://www.archives.pref.okinawa.jp/event_information/past_exhibitions/8558, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Chronology of wartime and postwar Kin: 1944-45 reconnaissance, the Yaka suicide-boat squadron, the 1 and 5 April 1945 landing/occupation dates, the Yaka detention camp, the airfield's postwar use as a firing range (1947) and the 1957 Marine build-up, and the town's own figure of about 56 percent of its area under US bases (as of the 2019 exhibition); also the 1899-1900 emigration (26 emigrants, 10 from Kin) and postwar emigration to Bolivia/Argentina/Brazil.
7. 土地と移民 [Land and emigration], 沖縄県公文書館 (Okinawa Prefectural Archives). https://www.archives.pref.okinawa.jp/event_information/past_exhibitions/6246, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 5 December 1899 departure from Naha and 8 January 1900 arrival at Honolulu; the 26 contract laborers on Oahu's sugar plantations; remittances reaching over 60 percent of prefectural revenue at their peak; the postwar Bolivia emigration program.
8. 當山久三より平良新助あて書簡 [Letter from Toyama Kyuzo to Taira Shinsuke], 沖縄県公文書館 (Okinawa Prefectural Archives), 1907. https://www.archives.pref.okinawa.jp/okinawa_related/6988, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Toyama's own 17 September 1907 account of having sent close to 5,000 Okinawans abroad (about 4,000 to Hawaii, the rest to Mexico, Peru, New Caledonia, the Philippines and Canada), and of founding an emigrants' protective association and newspaper.
9. 當山記念館 [Toyama Memorial Hall], 金武町 (Kin Town). <https://www.town.kin.okinawa.jp/soshiki/kikakuka/4/4/593.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Construction in 1935 by architect Oshiro Ryutarō, funding from the statue-fund surplus, the building's design and later uses, its 2016 restoration/reopening, and its 2021 registration as a national Registered Tangible Cultural Property.
10. 金武町について [About Kin Town], 金武町観光協会 (Kin Town Tourism Association), via the ラブKINライフ portal. https://love-kin-life.com/about_kin_town/, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Overview history from Jomon-era settlement through the Kin magiri, the Meiji-era village, Toyama's emigration movement, the Korean War-era construction of Camp Hansen, and the town's 1980 incorporation.
11. タコライス [Taco rice], 金武町観光協会 (Kin Town Tourism Association), via the ラブKINライフ portal. <https://love-kin-life.com/%E3%82%BF%E3%82%B3%E3%83%A9%E3%82%A4%E3%82%B9/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The town's own account of taco rice's invention around 1984 by Gibo Senri at Parlor Senri, to feed Camp Hansen servicemen cheaply, and its later spread across Okinawa.
12. 宜野座村の歴史 [History of Ginoza Village], 宜野座村 (Ginoza Village). <https://www.vill.ginoza.okinawa.jp/soshiki/1001/1/45.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 1 April 1946 separation of Kochiya, Ginoza, Sokei and Kanna from Kin village to form Ginoza; the pre-1908 grouping of those hamlets as part of Kin; and the 1872/1879/1896/1908 sequence of Okinawa's administrative reorganization.
13. レファレンス協同データベース：屋嘉節について知りたい [Collaborative Reference Database: a question about Yaka-bushi], 恩納村文化情報センター (Onna Village Culture Information Center), via NDL. https://crd.ndl.go.jp/reference/detail?page=ref_view&id=1000378164, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Confirms Kin's annual Yaka-bushi singing contest each August and points to local histories (金武町誌; 沖縄戦のはなし, Aniya Masaaki, 1997) that link the song to the wartime detention camp at Yaka.

14. 金武鍾乳洞（日秀洞） [Kin limestone cave (Nisshu Cave)], 文化庁 文化遺産オンライン (Agency for Cultural Affairs, Cultural Heritage Online database). <https://online.bunka.go.jp/heritages/detail/653186>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Official registration of the cave as a national Registered Monument on 17 February 2026, and its description (opening within the temple precinct, an inner chamber about 13 m high).
15. 日秀上人 (人物データベース) [Nisshu Shonin (biographical database entry)], JCC 沖縄関連人物データベース. https://art.jcc-okinawa.net/persons_detail.php?id=71, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Nisshu's approximate dates (1503-1577), his voyage and landing in Ryukyu, the cave and the three carved images, and his later work restoring Naminoue Shrine and Gokoku-ji in Naha.
16. <沖縄の伝説・歴史ぶらり歩き> 金武観音寺と日秀上人 [A walk through Okinawan legend and history: Kin Kannon-ji and Nisshu Shonin], OKINAWA CLIP. <https://www.okinawaclip.com/post/1701603804/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 1522 founding tradition, the temple's 1942 rebuilding, its survival of the 1945 battle as (by this account) the sole such building spared on Okinawa's main island, and the continuation of joint shrine-temple worship on the site.
17. 沖縄本島唯一4種類のマングローブが自生する億首川の風景を守りたい [Protecting the scenery of the Okukubi River, the only place on Okinawa's main island where all four mangrove species grow], 沖縄ネイチャーオフィス O.N.O. (Okinawa Nature Office). <https://okinawa-nature.com/protecting-the-scenery-of-okukubi-river/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Identifies the Okukubi River estuary as the only site on Okinawa's main island where all four native mangrove species (ohirugi, mehirugi, Yaeyama-hirugi and hirugi-modoki) grow together.
18. *Bago Oshiro, Davao City Profile* [Bago Oshiro, Davao City Profile], PhilAtlas. <https://www.philatlas.com/mindanao/r11/davao-city/bago-oshiro.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Confirms that Bago Oshiro, a present-day barangay of Davao City, commemorates Oshiro Kozo of the Ohta Development Company, who recruited the area's first Okinawan laborers in 1905.
19. *Memorial rock unveiled at Hawaii Okinawa Center* [Memorial rock unveiled at Hawaii Okinawa Center], Honolulu Star-Bulletin, 2000. <https://archives.starbulletin.com/2000/01/05/news/story3.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: An 18-ton marble stone from Kin, inscribed with Toyama's verse, unveiled at the Hawaii Okinawa Center on 8 January 2000, the centennial of the 1900 arrival in Honolulu.
20. *What's in a name? Okinawa bases named for fallen heroes* [What's in a name? Okinawa bases named for fallen heroes], DVIDS (US Department of Defense), story 73406, III Marine Expeditionary Force, 2011. <https://www.dvidshub.net/news/73406/whats-name-okinawa-bases-named-fallen-heroes>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Okinawa's Marine installations carry the names of eight Medal of Honor recipients of the battle, Camp Hansen among them.
21. *Dale Merlin Hansen — Medal of Honor recipient* [Dale Merlin Hansen — Medal of Honor recipient], Congressional Medal of Honor Society. <https://www.cmohs.org/recipients/dale-m-hansen>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Private Dale M. Hansen, USMC: action 7 May 1945 on Okinawa, died 11 May 1945, born in Wisner, Nebraska, awarded posthumously.
22. フィリピン移民の父 大城孝蔵 — 沖縄県金武町の偉人 — (金武町の民話シリーズ⑦) [Oshiro Kozo, father of Philippine emigration (Kin Town Library picture book, 2019)], 金武町立図書館 (Kin Town Library). <https://kin-lib.town.kin.okinawa.jp/06kyoudominwa.html>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Oshiro Kozo as the father of Philippine emigration: the 1904 emigration to Benguet, then abaca growing at Bago.

Further reading

- 金武町誌 (金武町誌編纂委員会編, 1983) — The town's first comprehensive gazetteer, covering the early-modern period through municipal administration; full-text search shows hits on 布哇 (Hawaii) at frames including 149 and 238. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/9774522> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 金武町史 第1巻 移民・本編 (金武町史編さん委員会編, 1996) — The town's dedicated emigration volume, covering Toyama Kyuzo and Kin's emigrants in far more depth than could be verified here; won the 1996 Okinawa Times Publishing Culture Award special prize. <https://ndlsearch.ndl.go.jp/books/R100000136-I1970867909896787850> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 金武町史 第2巻 戦争・本編 (金武町史編さん委員会編, 2002) — Wartime testimony from Kin residents, including experiences at the Yaka camp and among overseas emigrants caught up in the war. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/9640038> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 宜野座村誌 第1巻 (通史編) (宜野座村誌編集委員会編, 1991) — Ginoza's own village history, covering in detail the hamlets that separated from Kin in 1946 and their shared pre-war history with it. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13253009> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 時代の先駆者当山久三：沖縄現代史の一節 (湧川青栄著, 1953) — An early full-length biography of Toyama Kyuzo by a writer who knew the emigration movement at first hand. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/11441422> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 当山久三伝 (湧川清栄著, 1973) — A later, more documented biography of Toyama, useful for verifying the exact wording of his verse on the "World Stone", which this dossier could not confirm from a source read in this session. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/12285967> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- 日本移民の地理学的研究：沖縄・広島・山口 (石川友紀著, 1997) — An academic geography of Okinawan, Hiroshima and Yamaguchi emigration with statistical detail on Kin's contribution; NDL premises only. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13905031> (NDL premises only)

Where a Deep Research request would go next

- **Toyama Kyuzo's original papers, the exact text of the "World Stone" verse, and photographs of the 1899-1900 departure** — 沖縄県公文書館 (Okinawa Prefectural Archives), Naha, which holds Toyama's correspondence and exhibition materials. Search the Archives' online catalog for 当山久三 and 金武, or request an appointment to view originals in the reading room.

- **Individual emigration records for Kin villagers (ships, dates, destinations)** — 沖縄県立図書館の沖縄県系移民渡航記録データベース 1900-1941 (Okinawa Prefectural Library's emigrant travel-record database). Search the online database by home village (金武村/金武町) or by surname; the library's reference desk can advise on reading pre-war family registers alongside it.
- **Pre-1974 aerial photographs of Kin, the airfield/Camp Hansen site, and the 1945 landing beaches** — US National Archives (NARA), College Park, Maryland: wartime and occupation-era aerial photography and unit records (e.g. RG 127 US Marine Corps, RG 407 US Army). Search the NARA catalog by place name (Kin, Chimu) and unit; reproductions can be ordered remotely.
- **The full run of 金武町史 (1983, 1996, 2002) and any research since, including the war-testimony and immigration-testimony volumes** — 金武町教育委員会 社会教育課 町史編さん室 (Kin Town Board of Education, Town History Compilation Office) and Okinawa Prefectural Library. Contact the town's Board of Education directly for in-print volumes, or consult the Prefectural Library's local-history room.
- **Labor contracts and company records for Okinawan abaca workers at Davao** — 外交史料館 (Diplomatic Archives of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs), Tokyo, which holds pre-war passport and emigration-company records; Philippine-side archives in Davao/Manila. Request pre-war passport registers (旅券下付表) for Kunigami County by name; for the Philippine side, consult the Ateneo de Davao University's research collections on the pre-war Japanese community.

Caveats

- The 1919 Kunigami County gazetteer (S1) that this dossier leans on for early geography and history — the peaks and prewar ports, and the date of Kushi district's separation from Kin and Nago (1674 in the original research's reading of the gazetteer) — could not be retrieved as searchable text in this fact-check session (the online full-text index refused this book), so those specific details rest on the original research rather than an independent re-check here; a widely repeated secondary account instead dates the Kushi separation to 1673.
- Details of the wartime detention camp at Yaka (numbers held, exact closure date) are reported in secondary sources this dossier could not verify directly; only what the Prefectural Archives' own exhibition and a library reference answer support is stated here.
- The share of Kin's land occupied by US military facilities is given as an official exhibition reported it in 2019 (about 56 percent); current, precise figures were not independently retrieved in this session.

Digitised books are cited, not reproduced: the page frames let you open the same page in the NDL Digital Collections. Aerial photographs, landform and memorial data: GSI, processed by Japan Time Atlas. Positions of the walking stops: © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL), found with Nominatim. Photographs of the stops: Wikimedia Commons contributors, under the licences named beside each; scaled, not otherwise altered. This experimental edition was checked against its cited sources on 2026-09-28 but has not had independent fact-checking.